

end. I introduce several topics that you might only otherwise discover, piecemeal, through hard-earned experience. After completing this book, your footing will be on a firmer foundation so you'll be better equipped to take on new challenges.

Although I recommend you read the chapters in this book in order, feel free to skip to whichever chapters capture your interest:

Part I: Getting Started

Chapter 1: Dealing with Errors and Asking for Help Shows you how to effectively ask questions and find answers on your own. It also teaches you how to read error messages and the etiquette for asking for help online.

Chapter 2: Environment Setup and the Command Line Explains how to navigate the command line along with setting up your development environment and the `PATH` environment variable.

Part II: Best Practices, Tools, and Techniques

Chapter 3: Code Formatting with Black Describes the PEP 8 style guide and how to format your code to make it more readable. You'll learn how to automate this process using the Black code-formatting tool.

Chapter 4: Choosing Understandable Names Describes how you should name your variables and functions to improve code readability.

Chapter 5: Finding Code Smells Lists several potential red flags that could indicate the existence of bugs in your code.

Chapter 6: Writing Pythonic Code Details several ways to write idiomatic Python code and what makes for *Pythonic* code.

Chapter 7: Programming Jargon Explains technical terms used in the programming field and terms that are commonly confused with each other.